



GEN Z Expectations From HR: A Study On Flexibility, Mental Health Support And Digital Integration

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Abstract

Generation Z is rapidly emerging as a dominant segment of the global workforce, bringing distinct expectations shaped by digital transformation, globalization, and post-pandemic workplace realities. This study examines Gen Z expectations from Human Resource (HR) practices with specific focus on workplace flexibility, mental health support, and digital integration, and analyzes their impact on perceived HR effectiveness.

The research adopts a descriptive and analytical design using primary data collected from 80 Gen Z employees aged 22-27 across IT, service, and startup sectors. A structured questionnaire based on a 5-point Likert scale was used for data collection. Statistical tools such as descriptive statistics, reliability analysis (Cronbach's Alpha), correlation, and multiple regression were applied to analyze the data.

The findings indicate that all three independent variables-workplace flexibility, mental health support, and digital integration-have a significant positive relationship with HR effectiveness ($p < .01$). Reliability scores for all constructs exceeded 0.70, confirming internal consistency. Among the variables, digital integration recorded the highest mean score (4.10), reflecting Gen Z's strong preference for technology-enabled HR systems. However, regression analysis revealed that workplace flexibility ($\beta = .38$) is the strongest predictor of HR effectiveness, followed by mental health support ($\beta = .34$) and digital integration ($\beta = .29$). The model explains 52% of the variance in HR effectiveness ($R^2 = .52$), indicating substantial explanatory power.

The study concludes that organizations must redesign HR strategies to align with Gen Z expectations by implementing flexible work arrangements, strengthening mental health initiatives, and adopting advanced digital HR systems. These practices are essential for enhancing employee engagement, satisfaction, and retention in the evolving workforce landscape.

Keywords: *Generation Z, HR Effectiveness, Workplace Flexibility, Mental Health Support, Digital Integration*



1. Introduction & Statement of the Problem

Generation Z (born 1997-2012) is entering the workforce with expectations shaped by digital transformation, globalization, and post-pandemic workplace shifts. Organizations face high turnover among Gen Z employees due to misalignment between expectations and HR policies. This study examines how workplace flexibility, mental health support, and digital integration impact perceived HR effectiveness.



2. Research Methodology

The study employs a descriptive and analytical research design with a sample of 80 Gen Z employees aged 22-27 years across IT (45%), Services (35%), and Startups (20%), using a 5-point Likert scale structured questionnaire. Cronbach's Alpha values exceeded 0.70 across all constructs (Workplace Flexibility: 0.85, Mental Health Support: 0.82, Digital Integration: 0.88, HR Effectiveness: 0.86).



2. Research Methodology (Continued)

The study employs a descriptive and analytical research design with a sample of 80 Gen Z employees aged 22-27 years across IT (45%), Services (35%), and Startups (20%), using a 5-point Likert scale structured questionnaire. Cronbach's Alpha values exceeded 0.70 across all constructs (Workplace Flexibility: 0.85, Mental Health Support: 0.82, Digital Integration: 0.88, HR Effectiveness: 0.86).



3. Data Analysis & Findings

Among the variables, Digital Integration achieved the highest mean score (Mean = 4.10, SD = 0.69), followed by Flexibility (Mean = 3.98) and Mental Health (Mean = 3.85). Multiple regression analysis ($R^2 = .52$, $F = 27.45$, $p = .000$) shows Workplace Flexibility (beta = .38, $p = 0.000$) as the strongest predictor of HR Effectiveness, followed by Mental Health Support (beta = .34, $p = 0.001$) and Digital Integration (beta = .29, $p = 0.014$).



3. Data Analysis & Findings (Continued)

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4. Suggestions & Conclusion

Organizations must promote workplace flexibility through hybrid schedules and outcome-based evaluation, strengthen mental health support via counseling and mental health leave policies, and enhance digital integration using AI-driven and mobile-friendly HR systems to attract, engage, and retain Generation Z talent.



4. Suggestions & Conclusion (Continued)

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